

Question 53 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse why a training program may receive positive participant reactions but still fail to improve job performance.

Introduction

This is the gap between Kirkpatrick level 1 and levels 3–4. Analyse reasons in the programme, the person, and the workplace.

Detailed points

1. **Entertainment versus learning.** Funny trainer, good food, hill-station venue raise reaction. Skill may not have been practised. Level 2 never happened.
2. **Learning without difficulty.** Content too easy or too theoretical; people leave happy and incompetent.
3. **Wrong need (TNA missing).** Performance problem was tools, process, or target, not skill. Training cannot improve job performance then, however pleasant.
4. **No transfer climate.** Boss says ‘forget the classroom’. Peers mock new methods. Old SOP remains. Behaviour cannot change.
5. **No opportunity to use.** Skill unused for months is forgotten. Reaction was real; performance chance never came.
6. **Conflicting appraisal and rewards.** Taught quality; paid for speed. People follow pay. Analysis: systems beat training.
7. **No follow-up coaching.** One event without IDP, refreshers, or supervisor support. Decay of learning.
8. **Analytical conclusion.** Reaction is a weak predictor of job performance. HRD must design for learning, transfer support and results, not applause.

Conclusion. Give workplace and design reasons, not only ‘they were happy’. Close with the level-1 versus level-3 lesson.